

Crystal Obaretin

Chicago, IL | 713 - 385 - 4577 | crystaloba@gmail.com | crystaloba.github.io/me/ (Portfolio)

SUMMARY

UX Designer with 5+ years simplifying complex workflows and information into digital experiences that feel clear, accessible, and trustworthy across web and mobile. Experienced across the full user-centered design process while applying design systems, accessibility standards, and Figma to create consistent experiences. Comfortable collaborating closely with Product, Engineering, Research, and Content teams in Agile environments, and applying AI-powered tools including Claude to support design exploration and problem-solving.

SKILLS

UX Design: User flows, wireframes, prototypes, high-fidelity interfaces, interaction design, visual communication, layout, hierarchy, typography, pattern usage

Design Tools: Figma (components, auto-layout, variants, prototyping), Sketch, Adobe XD, Adobe Creative Suite, Miro

AI-Powered Tools: Claude, Figma AI, ChatGPT applied to design exploration, prototyping acceleration, and research synthesis

Design Systems: Design system component application, component libraries, design tokens, Tokens Studio, pattern libraries, reusable components

Accessibility: WCAG 2.1/2.2 AA, ADA, Section 508, A11y, inclusive design, accessibility best practices

Research & Testing: Research synthesis, usability testing, user interviews, heuristic analysis, UserZoom, UserTesting, Dovetail, A/B testing

Workflow: Agile/Scrum, Jira, cross-functional collaboration, design critiques, design rationale communication

RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Western Governors University

Salt Lake City, UT

UX Designer

September 2024 - Present

- Simplified complex enterprise workflows and information into digital experiences that feel clear, approachable, and trustworthy across desktop and mobile for 100+ digital assets used by learners and institutional partners.
- Designed user flows, wireframes, prototypes, and high-fidelity interfaces in Figma, translating business objectives, client needs, research insights, and technical constraints into consistent, accessible digital experiences.
- Applied established design system components and patterns to create consistent experiences across product lines, while identifying opportunities to improve clarity and usability within existing guidelines.
- Participated in design reviews, critiques, and working sessions, presenting design rationale clearly and incorporating feedback thoughtfully to improve the quality of the work across cross-functional teams.
- Explored AI-powered tools including Claude and Figma AI to support design exploration, prototyping, and problem-solving, contributing to an emerging practice for AI-assisted design

workflows.

- Partnered with Product, Engineering, Research, and Content teams in an Agile environment, raising risks and dependencies early and collaborating through implementation to ensure design quality and accessibility.

TopSpot

Houston, TX

UX Designer

July 2023 - August 2024

- Simplified complex B2B and healthcare workflows into digital experiences that felt clear and useful to end users, designing user flows, wireframes, prototypes, and high-fidelity interfaces across web and mobile platforms.
- Applied design systems and reusable component libraries in Figma to create consistent experiences, using established patterns while identifying opportunities to improve clarity and usability across 40+ client projects.
- Synthesized research insights, analytics, and usability testing findings to guide design decisions, presenting rationale clearly to stakeholders while staying open to feedback and new information.
- Collaborated closely with engineers throughout implementation, understanding how design decisions affected technical feasibility and raising dependencies early to help cross-functional teams make informed decisions.
- Contributed to design critiques and working sessions in an Agile environment, sharing work early and giving and receiving direct, constructive feedback that improved the quality of the work

Coforma

Washington, DC

Design and Research Associate (Contract)

July 2022 - March 2023

- Simplified complex federal government workflows into accessible, trustworthy digital experiences for Medicare web products in a highly regulated environment, applying WCAG, ADA, and Section 508 accessibility standards throughout.
- Designed user flows, wireframes, and high-fidelity Figma interfaces, applying established design system components and patterns and contributing documentation that maintained consistency across cross-functional teams.
- Synthesized usability research findings and iterated on designs based on testing and feedback, producing a 30% improvement in user satisfaction scores and presenting research-driven decisions to executive stakeholders.

EDUCATION

Rice University

Houston, TX

Certificate in UI/UX

University of Texas at San Antonio

San Antonio, TX

Bachelor of Science in Public Health